

Seat Comfort and Value for Money

ETM1005 - Assignment 2 Part B: Management Report
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Executive Management Message

Management should prioritise understanding whether passengers feel that their seat experience is worth the price paid. In the personalised sample of 600 reviews, most seat comfort ratings were positive, but 25.5% were low ratings of 1 or 2. This group deserves attention. I recommend starting with passengers who gave low seat comfort ratings in Economy and Business Class. Their feedback could help management understand the reasons for dissatisfaction before deciding whether changes to seats, services or pricing are needed.

Customer Experience Assessment

The overall passenger experience was divided. The mean overall rating was 5.90 out of 10, but 119 reviews gave a rating of 1 and 132 gave a rating of 10. These two extremes accounted for 41.8% of the sample, so the mean alone does not fully describe the experience. Although 56.5% of reviews recommended the airline, 43.5% did not.

Seat comfort received a mean rating of 3.46 out of 5. Ratings of 4 or 5 accounted for 55.5% of reviews, while ratings of 1 or 2 accounted for 25.5%. This suggests that many passengers were satisfied with their seats, but a substantial group reported a poor experience.

Recommendation rates were generally higher in the higher seat-rating groups, reaching 65.41% for rating 5 compared with 46.07% for rating 1. However, the pattern was not consistent at every level. The rating 3 group had a recommendation rate of 46.49%, below the 54.69% for rating 2.

This difference remained within Economy and Business Class. In Economy Class, the rating 3 group had lower value-for-money ratings than the rating 2 group, at 2.87 compared with 3.04. Their recommendation rates were also lower, at 44.58% compared with 53.19%. Business Class showed a similar pattern: value-for-money ratings were 3.16 compared with 3.79, and recommendation rates were 52.00% compared with 64.29%. However, staff service and food ratings were higher in the rating 3 groups. These mixed results suggest that seat comfort alone does not fully explain recommendation decisions.

Management Priority

The first action should be a focused customer feedback investigation covering seat comfort and perceived value for money. Economy and Business Class provide a sensible starting point because they account for 424 and 143 reviews respectively, giving more evidence than the smaller travel-class groups.

Within these classes, management should first seek feedback from passengers who gave seat comfort a rating of 1 or 2. They have clearly expressed dissatisfaction with their seats, although this does not mean they necessarily gave the lowest value-for-money ratings.

The customer-experience team could ask: "Considering the fare you paid, was the seat comfort worth the price? Why or why not? Please explain if other services affected your judgement." This would help separate complaints about physical comfort from concerns about expectations and the wider experience.

Immediate seat replacement or fare reductions would be premature. Lower perceived value could reflect several issues, and the current findings do not identify the cause. Customer feedback should guide the next step, alongside checks of seat condition and an assessment of fares, service offerings and costs.

If feedback mainly points to problems with the physical condition of seats, management should prioritise technical inspections before deciding on repairs or replacement. If concerns mainly involve a mismatch between the fare paid and the service expected, management should review how seat features and included services are explained and whether the overall offering provides reasonable value.

Decision Confidence

The evidence provides a reasonable basis for a targeted investigation, but limited support for major investment or pricing decisions. The sample contains reviews across several airlines and does not necessarily represent all passengers or any single airline. It also shows associations rather than cause and effect.

Some comparisons involve small groups. The Business Class seat-rating 2 and 3 groups contain only 14 and 25 reviews, while First Class has eight reviews in total. The dataset also lacks actual fares paid and seat inspection records. Management should therefore use these findings to identify questions for investigation, rather than assume that replacing seats or reducing prices will improve recommendations.

Evidence source: Personalised Part A notebook, including the service assessment, travel-class comparisons and Results Fingerprint.